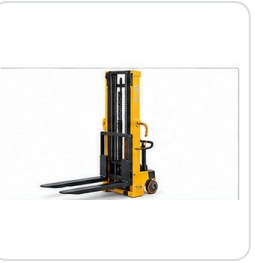
Stacker



Category: **Retail, Logistics & Warehouse** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Stacker

What it is used for

A stacker lifts and moves palletised goods over short distances in warehouses, stores, and loading areas. Correct load assessment, stable stacking, controlled travel, and safe parking help prevent tipping, collisions, falling loads, and operator injuries.

Main parts

- Mast guides the lifting carriage vertically.
- Forks support the pallet or load.
- Hydraulic lifting system raises and lowers the forks.
- Load backrest supports the load where fitted.
- Steering handle or tiller controls direction on powered models.
- Drive wheel and load wheels allow movement.
- Control levers or buttons operate lifting and travel functions.
- Battery and charger power electric stackers where fitted.
- Emergency stop and braking system help stop movement.

Before you start

1. Only trained and authorised operators should use the stacker.
2. Inspect the stacker, forks, mast, wheels, chains, hydraulic lines, controls, and safety devices for damage or leakage.
3. Check the nameplate for rated capacity, load centre, and maximum lift height.
4. Confirm that the pallet is sound and the load is stable, secured, and within the stacker's rated capacity.
5. Check the travel route for people, uneven flooring, ramps, overhead obstructions, and narrow passages.
6. Verify battery charge or fuel status and confirm brakes, horn, steering, and emergency stop function correctly.
7. Wear suitable safety footwear and any site-required PPE.

How to use

1. Approach the pallet slowly and align the stacker with the load.
2. Lower the forks and insert them fully under the pallet without striking the load.
3. Confirm the load is centred and distributed evenly across both forks.
4. Raise the load only enough to clear the floor and check stability before travelling.
5. Travel at a controlled speed with the load low and the route in view.

6. Use the horn at blind corners and intersections according to site rules.
7. Avoid sudden turns, sharp braking, and travel across slopes beyond the equipment's limits.
8. Position the stacker squarely at the destination and stop before raising the load.
9. Raise the load to the required height and place it gently on the designated stable surface.
10. Lower the forks until the load is fully supported, then withdraw the forks carefully.
11. Lower the forks to a safe travel position, park in the designated area, apply the brake, and switch off the unit.
12. Connect the charger only in the designated charging area and according to the equipment instructions.

⚠ Safety

- Never exceed the rated capacity or lift a load that blocks safe visibility without an approved travel method.
- Keep people clear of the forks, mast, load, and turning area.
- Never allow anyone to stand or pass under raised forks or a suspended load.
- Do not carry passengers or use the stacker to lift people unless it is specifically designed and approved for that purpose.
- Do not operate with damaged forks, faulty brakes, leaking hydraulics, or malfunctioning controls.
- Lower the forks and isolate the equipment before inspection or maintenance; follow battery charging and handling precautions.

Care & storage

- Inspect forks, mast, wheels, chains, brakes, and hydraulic components before each shift.
- Keep the stacker clean and remove debris from wheels and moving parts.
- Check battery condition and charge it using the approved charger where applicable.
- Report leaks, unusual noises, steering problems, and safety-device faults immediately.
- Arrange scheduled maintenance and remove unsafe equipment from service until repaired.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Lifting a load beyond the rated capacity or with an unstable pallet.
- Travelling with the load raised too high.
- Turning sharply or travelling too fast on an uneven surface.
- Leaving the stacker parked with raised forks or without applying the brake.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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